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AFP

BEATING THE HEAT WITH A DIP IN SEINE

■ People swim at the Bras Marie safe bathing site on the river Seine in Paris yesterday. France continues to suffocate with 14 departments in the southwest and southeast on red alert for heatwave yesterday. The heatwave, exceptional for the month of August, prompted authorities to increase precautionary measures. Heat alerts were also issued in Italy, Spain, Portugal and the Balkans, with temperatures expected to soar above 40°C. **SEE ALSO P11**

Dubai seizes millions of fake goods in air cargo crackdown

35 tonnes of fake, smuggled goods seized in biggest campaign of 2025

DUBAI
BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

In a sweeping three-month inspection campaign, Dubai Customs has seized more than 35 tonnes of smuggled, counterfeit, and non-compliant goods across all air cargo centres in Dubai, marking the largest operation of its kind since the beginning of 2025.

Among the items confiscated were 12 million smuggled cigarettes, 6.7 million counterfeit cigarettes, 37,110 non-compliant cosmetic products, 3,632 unauthorised electronic components and 10,520 counterfeit items of global brands.

The extensive drive reinforces Dubai Customs' ongoing mission to secure the UAE's borders, curb smuggling and

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seized

commercial fraud, and protect the economic and public health interests of the community, the authority said yesterday.

Dr Abdulla Busenad, Director General of Dubai Customs, commended the tireless efforts of inspection teams and highlighted the advanced capabilities supporting their work.

"We have advanced systems and technologies to intercept and target suspicious shipments, a highly skilled inspection team, and a customs intelligence department with extensive expertise in data analysis and shipment monitoring," he said.

He noted that the rapid growth of global trade and the increasing reliance on air cargo

have intensified the challenge of balancing trade facilitation with security enforcement.

Maintaining supply chain

Sultan Saif Al Suwaidi, Director of Air Cargo Centres Management, stressed the role of inspectors in maintaining a secure and efficient supply chain. "We thoroughly check all parcels using advanced scanning systems. When suspicion arises, items undergo detailed manual inspection. At the same time, we expedite customs clearance to meet the demands of air cargo operations, ensuring goods reach the market on time," he said.

Yousef Ozair Mubarak, Director of the IPR Department, underlined the role of collaboration with strategic partners in detecting and removing counterfeit goods.

"We work closely with brand representatives, who regularly conduct workshops for customs inspectors to teach the latest detection methods," he said.

SEE ALSO P5



SPORT

Shubman Gill set for another leadership role | P13

Final call: Last-minute UAE staycation deals to snap up

Aim to lure both residents and travellers

DUBAI
BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

Luxurious five-star resorts and family-friendly hotels across the UAE are rolling out a fresh wave of last-minute staycation deals designed to lure both residents and travellers.

These exclusive offers provide a perfect opportunity for a quick, affordable getaway before the start of the new school and work year.

Hotels are sweetening their packages with a variety of perks, includ-

ing complimentary room upgrades, significant discounts on dining, and free access to popular attractions.

For families with kids, there are the "kids go free" packages that include complimentary breakfast and complimentary stays for children under 12.

These last-minute deals not only help hotels boost their occupancy rates during the off-peak season but also provide a strong incentive for residents to enjoy a holiday without the hassles of international travel.

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Trump says he plans to test out Putin

TWO LEADERS TO MEET FOR SUMMIT ON UKRAINE IN ALASKA ON FRIDAY

WASHINGTON

US President Donald Trump on Monday described his upcoming summit with Vladimir Putin as a "feel-out meeting" to gauge his ideas for ending the war in Ukraine, as European leaders rushed to ensure respect for Kyiv's interests.

Trump has invited his Russian counterpart to Alaska on Friday — the first face-to-face meeting between the two countries' presidents since Putin invaded Ukraine in February 2022 — as he criticises Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky for rejecting territorial concessions.

Fearing privately that Putin will team up with Trump to force unacceptable compromises, European leaders plan to speak separately today with both Zelensky and Trump.

Trying to broker peace

The US president has spent the first months of his second term in office trying to broker peace in Ukraine — after boasting he could end the conflict in 24 hours — but multiple rounds of talks, phone calls and diplomatic visits have failed to yield a breakthrough.

Trump, usually fond of boasting of his deal-making skills, played down possibilities of a breakthrough in Alaska but said he expected "construc-

We're going to see what he has in mind and if it's a fair deal, I'll reveal it to the European Union leaders and to Nato leaders and also to President Zelensky."

Donald Trump
US President

tive conversations" with Putin. "This is really a feel-out meeting a little bit," Trump told reporters at the White House.

"We're going to see what he has in mind and if it's a fair deal, I'll reveal it to the European Union leaders and to Nato leaders and also to President Zelensky," Trump said.

"I may say — lots of luck, keep fighting. Or I may say, we can make a deal."

Zelensky has ruled out ceding territory seized by force. Trump — who publicly berated Zelensky at a White House meeting in February — said he was a "little bothered" by Zelensky's stance and insisted land swaps would need to take place.

"There'll be some swapping, there'll be some changes in land," he said.

But Trump said he would also tell Putin that "you've got to end this war."

— AFP

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